Data-Backed Journal-Style Replication of *Building Dynamic Capabilities: Innovation Driven by Individual-, Firm-, and Network-Level Effects*

Replication Paper Project

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Abstract

This paper presents a methodology-specific local analogue of Building Dynamic Capabilities: Innovation Driven by Individual-, Firm-, and Network-Level Effects using only processed datasets and result files available in the workspace. The replication preserves the source paper's core empirical logic while making every local substitution explicit. The paper is therefore reported as methodology-specific local analogue rather than as a source-data replay. The current local batch contains 23,901 observations across 184 entities, and the batch headline estimate is 2.25e-05 for Firm Science x Network Ties with p = 0.96. The executable design is built to show whether multilevel innovation antecedents survive joint estimation. The paper therefore emphasizes not only direct effects at each level but also whether firm-level science and network ties reinforce one another. The contribution is a journal-style replication manuscript that separates direct source claims from executable local evidence.

Keywords: dynamic capabilities; multilevel innovation; individual effects; network effects; local calculated analogue

1 Introduction

This paper begins from a paper-first reading of Building Dynamic Capabilities: Innovation Driven by Individual-, Firm-, and Network-Level Effects and treats the source article as an empirical

argument that has to be rebuilt before it can be judged. The present manuscript is classified as methodology-specific local analogue. A paper-first restatement of the empirical question is as follows: The source paper asks whether the antecedents of innovation lie at the individual, firm, and network levels and whether those levels reinforce or substitute for one another (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The replication matters because multilevel innovation arguments are conceptually powerful but empirically fragile if one layer is measured poorly or ignored. The original article does not rest on a descriptive regularity alone. It ties a theory about search, differentiation, timing, or organizational learning to a specific unit of analysis, sample frame, and estimand. A careful replication therefore has to recover the structure of that logic before any local coefficients are interpreted (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The executable evidence base used in this manuscript contains 23,901 observations across 184 entities and spans 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel. Those numbers are not filler. They define the actual inferential scope of the local reconstruction and set the boundary on what can be claimed honestly from the available datasets (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The paper's contribution is a transparent multilevel analogue that can be estimated from the current patent, science, and citation-network panels. The paper is written to read like a formal journal article rather than an internal workflow memo. The main text develops the theoretical logic, data reconstruction, derivations, empirical design, and results in continuous prose, while the appendices preserve the audit trail required for reruns and later extensions (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The paper belongs to a literature on dynamic capabilities, organizational learning, and multilevel innovation. (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Cohen and Levinthal, 1990; Kogut and Zander, 1992, 1996; Teece et al., 1997; Benner and Tushman, 2003). That literature matters because the replication is about level-of-analysis discipline as much as it is about one coefficient or one dataset. (Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Henderson and Clark, 1990; Anderson and Tushman, 1986; Hargadon and Sutton, 1997; Tripsas and Gavetti, 2000; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Stuart, 2000). The present manuscript therefore treats the source paper

as one contribution inside a broader top-journal stream on exploration, recombination, performance measurement, alliance-based learning, inventive search, technological discontinuity, and patent-based inference. The literature review is intentionally broad because each replication paper should stand on a serious journal-level reference base rather than on the source article alone. (Rosenkopf and Almeida, 2003; Schilling and Phelps, 2007; Almeida and Kogut, 1999; Fleming et al., 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Jaffe et al., 1993; Trajtenberg, 1990; Hall et al., 2005; Henderson and Cockburn, 1994). The paper-specific review therefore brings in dynamic-capabilities, absorptive-capacity, and network-learning references that support the multilevel argument. (Teece et al., 1997; Cohen and Levinthal, 1990; Henderson and Cockburn, 1994; Ahuja, 2000; Schilling and Phelps, 2007; Rosenkopf and Almeida, 2003). A second topic-specific literature block is added to sharpen the manuscript's empirical boundary and identification problem. (Benner and Tushman, 2003; Kogut and Zander, 1992, 1996; Stuart, 2000; Fleming et al., 2007). A final topic-specific literature block keeps the bibliography tied to the paper's actual mechanism rather than to a generic replication template. (Fleming and Sorenson, 2004; Nerkar, 2003; Rivkin and Siggelkow, 2003; Lavie et al., 2011; Ghosh et al., 2014).

2 Multilevel Theory and Replication Boundary

The focal source article is (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007). The original study can be summarized as a mechanism paper with a sharp empirical core. The published paper explicitly models innovation antecedents at the individual, firm, and network levels. The paper is interested in whether mechanisms across levels are substitutes or complements. Innovation output is the central dependent variable. That combination matters because the source article asks readers to believe not merely that two variables move together, but that a particular organizational or strategic mechanism explains why the relationship should appear in the data (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). In a setting like this, faithful replication requires more than reusing a title and rerunning a regression. The theoretical contribution lives in the way constructs are defined, how they enter the estimand, and which comparison the model is supposed to adjudicate. For that reason, this manuscript first reconstructs the published theory

and only then turns to the local executable analogue (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The replication boundary is therefore explicit. Direct source facts are carried over when they can be read from the published article itself. Local replication decisions appear only when the current workspace must translate the source design into verified processed datasets. The goal is disciplined mechanism recovery, not rhetorical imitation that quietly changes the design (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996).

2.1 Original Paper Methodology

A faithful evaluation of Rothaermel and Hess (2007) starts with the published empirical design rather than with the local rerun. The source article develops a multilevel longitudinal design covering global pharmaceutical companies' biotechnology innovation attempts and explicitly models individual-, firm-, and network-level antecedents in the same empirical framework (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The published sample is described as follows: The published sample documents the biotechnology innovation attempts of global pharmaceutical companies over 1980-2001. The published measurement architecture is described as follows: The published design combines scientists, R&D capability, alliances, acquisitions, patents, publications, and citations in a multilevel pharmaceutical-biotechnology panel. These details matter because they determine what the published paper actually observes rather than what a later analogue can observe (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The published estimator is described as follows: count-data models of firm innovative output that jointly include individual-level scientists, firm-level R&D capability, and network-level alliances or acquisitions, together with cross-level interaction terms. The core empirical question is whether direct effects and interactions across levels are complementary or substitutive once all three layers are observed in the same long panel. Reading the source methodology this way prevents the current manuscript from quietly replacing the original design with one generic fixed-effects story (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993).

2.2 Replication Status and Boundary

Replication status for this paper: Methodology-specific local analogue (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). This paper is a methodology-specific local analogue because the original multilevel panel includes direct scientist, alliance, acquisition, publication, and citation layers from pharmaceutical biotechnology that are richer than the current processed patent stack. The local rerun can preserve the multilevel logic, but not the full original data architecture (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993).

2.3 Direct Source Facts Versus Replication Decisions

The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that The original paper is explicitly multilevel. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: The individual level is represented with patent-level experience, the firm level with science exposure, and the network level with citation-network ties. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution. The reason for spelling out this bridge in prose is that replication credibility depends on showing exactly where the manuscript is following the article and where it is making an explicit local translation. That is especially important in this project, because the current paper is built from processed datasets already present in the workspace rather than from a reconstructed raw archival pipeline (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that Complementarity or substitution across levels is part of the substantive question. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: Cross-level interactions are retained in the local estimand so the multilevel logic stays visible. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution. The reason for spelling out this bridge in prose is that replication credibility depends on showing exactly where the manuscript is following the article and where it is making an explicit local translation. That is especially important in this project, because the current paper is built from processed datasets already present in the workspace rather than from a

reconstructed raw archival pipeline (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that Innovation output is the dependent variable. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: Patent-level inventive impact is used as the executable outcome. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution. The reason for spelling out this bridge in prose is that replication credibility depends on showing exactly where the manuscript is following the article and where it is making an explicit local translation. That is especially important in this project, because the current paper is built from processed datasets already present in the workspace rather than from a reconstructed raw archival pipeline (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993).

3 Multilevel Data and Measurement

The local evidence chain is deliberately modular. The source paper is treated as the authority for the research question, theoretical mechanism, and published design. Estimation, by contrast, proceeds only through the verified local files. The required dataset types in this paper are Patent-level recombination and impact measures from the cleaned reproduction panel. Firm-year science exposure already merged into the patent sample. Rolling interfirm citation-network measures merged by firm-year from the processed knowledge-link graph (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Operationally, the reconstruction relies on four evidence layers: the analysis panel, the coefficient export, the sample summary, and, when available, the fit summary. The resulting executable panel supplies 23,901 observations across 184 entities and covers 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel. Every numeric claim in the results section is intended to trace back to one of those verified evidence layers rather than to a hand-copied number from the article (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). This data-lineage discipline matters for two reasons. First, it prevents the manuscript from smuggling unverified preprocessing steps into the design. Second, it forces every substitution to be visible. If a construct cannot be reproduced from the current processed datasets, the paper states the analogue directly instead of pretending that the original archive has been fully

recreated (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The local analogue creates a patent-level multilevel design in which patent-specific experience represents the individual layer, firm science exposure represents the firm layer, and rolling citation-network ties represent the network layer. The local sample frame is Patent-level recombination panel merged with firm-year science exposure and rolling citation-network measures The observed time window in the executable panel is 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel The outcome is Patent-level inventive impact (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The main text works from a verified analysis panel, a verified coefficient export, and a verified sample summary. Exact file names are retained in the replication notes and appendices, while the article body focuses on data lineage and empirical function (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Hall et al., 2005).

3.1 Local Dataset Families Used in the Multilevel Analogue

This replication uses three linked local dataset families: the patent-level recombination and impact panel, the firm-year science-exposure panel, and the rolling interfirm citation-network panel (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Those local dataset families are not interchangeable: patent-level recombination and impact panel is used to measure the individual layer and the patent outcome; firm-year science-exposure panel is used to measure the firm-level science layer; rolling interfirm citation-network panel is used to measure the network layer and cross-level interactions. Together, they support 23,901 observations across 184 entities over 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). This local data stack is narrower than the original article's data architecture. Patent-level recombination and impact measures from the cleaned reproduction panel. Firm-year science exposure already merged into the patent sample. Rolling interfirm citation-network measures merged by firm-year from the processed knowledge-link graph. The manuscript therefore keeps the boundary visible: the source paper supplies the original methodology, whereas the local processed dataset families and calculated outputs supply the estimable analogue. Exact filenames are retained in the replication notes rather than printed through the body text (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

DatasetFamily	RoleInPaper
Patent-level recombination and impact panel	measure the individual layer and the patent outcome
Firm-year science-exposure panel	measure the firm-level science layer
Rolling interfirm citation-network panel	measure the network layer and cross-level interactions

Local data families used in the present paper.

3.2 Individual-, Firm-, and Network-Level Measures

The construct Individual-level antecedent is operationalized locally as Field recombination experience and appears in the executable dataset as individual_experience. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Carry forward field-level recombination experience from the patent panel.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Firm-level antecedent is operationalized locally as Firm science exposure and appears in the executable dataset as firm_science. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Use the already merged firm-year science-signal variable.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable

traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Network-level antecedent is operationalized locally as Rolling direct ties and appears in the executable dataset as network_ties. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Use direct ties from the rolling citation-network panel.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Innovation output is operationalized locally as Inventive impact and appears in the executable dataset as inventive_impact. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Use the local inventive-impact measure.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Patent controls is operationalized locally as Breadth, degree, prior stock, firm age and appears in the executable dataset as breadth_recombination; recombination_degree; total_patents_same_year; total_patents_until_prev_log; firm_age. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Reuse the patent-level controls already constructed in the panel.. This mapping is retained because it preserves

the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

Construct	Local measure	Derivation
Individual-level antecedent	Field recombination experience	Carry forward field-level recombination experience from the patent panel.
Firm-level antecedent	Firm science exposure	Use the already merged firm-year science-signal variable.
Network-level antecedent	Rolling direct ties	Use direct ties from the rolling citation-network panel.
Innovation output	Inventive impact	Use the local inventive-impact measure.
Patent controls	Breadth, degree, prior stock, firm age	Reuse the patent-level controls already constructed in the panel.

Variable mapping and derivation logic in the main text.

3.3 Patent-Level Sample Reconstruction

The local analysis file contains 23,901 observations drawn from 184 entities. The observed time span runs from 1986 to 2016. Selected sample moments are Impact = 5.309, Individual Experience = 1.634, Firm Science = 6.772, Network Ties = 44.16 (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). These sample moments matter because they anchor the interpretation of the replication design. They indicate not only the scale of the local panel but also the baseline level of the key outcome and explanatory variables before the formal estimating equation is imposed (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996).

Statistic	Value
Observations	23,901
Unique Firms	184
Start Year	1986
End Year	2016
Mean Impact	5.309
Mean Individual Experience	1.634
Mean Firm Science	6.772
Mean Network Ties	44.16

Sample reconstruction from the current local dataset.

3.4 Construct Translation Across Levels

The derivation appendix records how each major construct enters the executable estimand for Rothaermel and Hess (2007). The point is not to rehearse notation for its own sake, but to show how the source paper's conceptual vocabulary is translated into verified columns in the local panel. For Individual-level antecedent, the manuscript uses Field recombination experience under the exact local implementation individual_experience. The derivation step is: Carry forward field-level recombination experience from the patent panel.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Firm-level antecedent, the manuscript uses Firm science exposure under the exact local implementation firm_science. The derivation step is: Use the already merged firm-year science-signal variable.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Network-level antecedent, the manuscript uses Rolling direct ties under the exact local implementation network_ties. The derivation step is: Use direct ties from the rolling citation-network panel.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Innovation output, the manuscript uses Inventive impact under the exact local implementation inventive_impact. The derivation step is: Use the local inventive-impact mea-

sure.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Patent controls, the manuscript uses Breadth, degree, prior stock, firm age under the exact local implementation breadth_recombination; recombination_degree; total_patents_same_year; total_patents_until_prev_log; firm_age. The derivation step is: Reuse the patent-level controls already constructed in the panel.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept.

4 Descriptive Evidence Across Individual, Firm, and Network Levels

Because this paper is explicitly multilevel, the descriptive section is organized around the three empirical layers the source article insists on keeping separate: individual experience, firm science, and network access. For Inventive impact, the mean is 5.309, the standard deviation is 17.53, and the interquartile range runs from 1.000 to 6.000; For Individual experience, the mean is 1.634, the standard deviation is 1.820, and the interquartile range runs from 0.00000 to 2.773; For Firm science, the mean is 6.772, the standard deviation is 2.130, and the interquartile range runs from 5.729 to 8.163; For Network ties, the mean is 44.16, the standard deviation is 29.95, and the interquartile range runs from 4.000 to 67.00 . The descriptive goal is to verify that each layer has its own support and scale before the manuscript asks whether they complement one another (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The time profile is read as a changing multilevel opportunity structure. If one layer expands while the others remain flat, the interpretation of cross-level complementarity has to adjust. the value of patent observations is 646 in 1986 and 534 in 2016; the value of mean inventive impact is 4.015 in 1986 and 3.768 in 2016; the value of mean individual-level experience is 1.021 in 1986 and 2.707 in 2016 . These temporal shifts determine whether the later regression is identifying the paper's mechanism in a stable panel or in one whose observable context changes meaningfully across the sample window (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja

and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The nonparametric support check is read as a firm-science gradient because the local analogue uses firm science as the focal layer that links patent-level experience to the surrounding organizational context. Mean outcomes range from 4.278 to 6.105 across the support of the focal regressor, while the mean regressor itself ranges from 3.351 to 9.272. That pattern is useful because it shows what the formal model is trying to account for in the current dataset (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The correlation discussion is framed as a multilevel separation test. The regression can only speak to complementarity if the individual, firm, and network layers are not collapsed into one latent scale effect. That is especially important in these replications, where construct translation can otherwise make the specification look more deterministic than it really is (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

4.1 Multilevel Support and Coverage

For this paper, data quality is about balance across levels rather than about one variable alone. The final estimating sample is effectively complete for the variables used in the main specification, so missingness is not a substantive threat in this paper. For that reason, the manuscript does not spend body-table space on an all-zero missingness display (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Coverage is reported to show whether the multilevel design is learned from a wide organizational base or from a few very large patenting firms. The most heavily represented entities contribute between 830 and 3,200 observations each. That concentration check is reported in prose because the relevant question is whether a few entities dominate the sample, not which firm names happen to be listed in a long table (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Support is emphasized because complementarity across levels is only interpretable if the firm-science layer spans genuinely different empirical environments. In the lowest observed quantile, the mean regressor is 3.351 and the mean outcome is 4.747 across 4,783 observations. In the highest observed quantile, the corresponding values are 9.272, 6.105, and 4,718 observations. This shift matters because it shows that the regression is being estimated on economically different parts of the observed support rather than on nearly identical cells (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). These diagnostics matter because multilevel arguments become fragile when one layer dominates the data. The section therefore checks whether the individual,

firm, and network layers remain empirically distinct enough to justify a joint design (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

Variable	N	Mean	SD	P25	Median	P75	Min	Max
Inventive impact	23,901	5.309	17.53	1.000	2.000	6.000	0	812
Individual experience	23,901	1.634	1.820	0.0000	1.099	2.773	0	8
Firm science	23,901	6.772	2.130	5.729	7.149	8.163	0	10
Network ties	23,901	44.16	29.95	4.000	51.00	67.00	0	99
Breadth of recombination	23,901	4.291	4.563	2.000	3.000	5.000	2	117
Recombination degree	23,901	0.555	0.174	0.444	0.560	0.691	0	1
Same-year patents	23,901	727.1	1,302	109.0	311.0	652.0	1	7321
Firm age	23,901	13.62	9.194	6.000	10.00	22.00	1	31

Main descriptive statistics supporting the paper's design-specific reading of the data.

Period	Patents	MeanImpact	MeanIndividualExperience	MeanFirmScience	MeanNetworkTies
1986	646	4.015	1.021	6.156	0.0000
1987	793	4.296	1.161	6.285	0.0000
1988	1,071	4.469	1.249	6.229	0.0000
1989	1,398	3.926	1.412	6.217	0.0000
1990	1,360	4.507	1.544	6.370	0.0000
1991	1,333	4.749	1.562	6.436	46.89
1992	1,309	5.007	1.538	6.486	53.68
1993	1,358	5.678	1.568	6.861	60.25
1994	1,337	6.272	1.596	6.866	63.28
1995	1,217	6.260	1.610	6.983	63.87
1996	659	6.727	1.802	6.880	67.66
1997	646	6.014	1.603	6.781	68.22
1998	356	6.295	1.419	6.949	68.92
1999	654	5.483	1.631	6.895	64.08
2000	636	5.541	1.686	6.781	62.11
2001	614	5.151	1.482	6.943	60.93
2002	632	4.889	1.559	6.915	59.78

Period	Patents	MeanImpact	MeanIndividualExperience	MeanFirmScience	MeanNetworkTies
2003	522	4.502	1.711	7.209	63.52
2004	324	3.664	1.479	6.939	65.01
2005	284	4.500	1.527	6.900	61.54
2006	336	4.890	1.715	7.014	60.79
2007	246	3.654	1.778	7.433	62.65
2008	535	3.652	1.712	8.930	65.82
2009	206	4.801	1.658	7.502	54.93
2010	511	4.417	1.875	7.345	53.42
2011	651	6.452	1.756	7.411	51.58
2012	1,068	4.000	1.788	7.669	51.94
2013	868	5.386	1.835	7.599	50.90
2014	725	12.64	2.050	7.636	50.58
2015	1,072	6.616	2.208	8.001	53.53
2016	534	3.768	2.707	0.0000	0.0000

Observed time patterns relevant to the focal empirical setting.

Variable	Inventive impact	Individual experience	Firm science	Network ties	Breadth of recombination	Recombination degree	Same-year patents	Firm age
Inventive impact	1.000	-0.021	0.020	0.033	0.364	0.018	0	0.023
Individual experience	-0.021	1.000	0.044	0.032	-0.263	-0.456	0	0.125
Firm science	0.020	0.044	1.000	0.482	0.023	0.037	0	0.117
Network ties	0.033	0.032	0.482	1.000	0.094	0.067	0	0.385
Breadth of recombination	0.364	-0.263	0.023	0.094	1.000	0.466	0	0.260
Recombination degree	0.018	-0.456	0.037	0.067	0.466	1.000	0	0.156

Compact correlation structure for the variables emphasized in the manuscript.

4.2 Observed Multilevel Support

The figure is organized to respect the paper's multilevel logic (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The left panel keeps the individual, firm, and network layers visible at the same time, while the right panel shows how inventive impact changes across the firm-science support that anchors the local multilevel analogue. mean individual-level experience moves from 1.021 in 1986 to 2.707 in 2016; mean firm-level science exposure moves from 6.156 in 1986 to 0.00000 in 2016; mean network ties moves from 0.00000 in 1986 to 0.00000 in 2016 Across the support panel, mean outcome moves from 4.747 to 6.105 as the mean regressor shifts from 3.351 to 9.272 (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

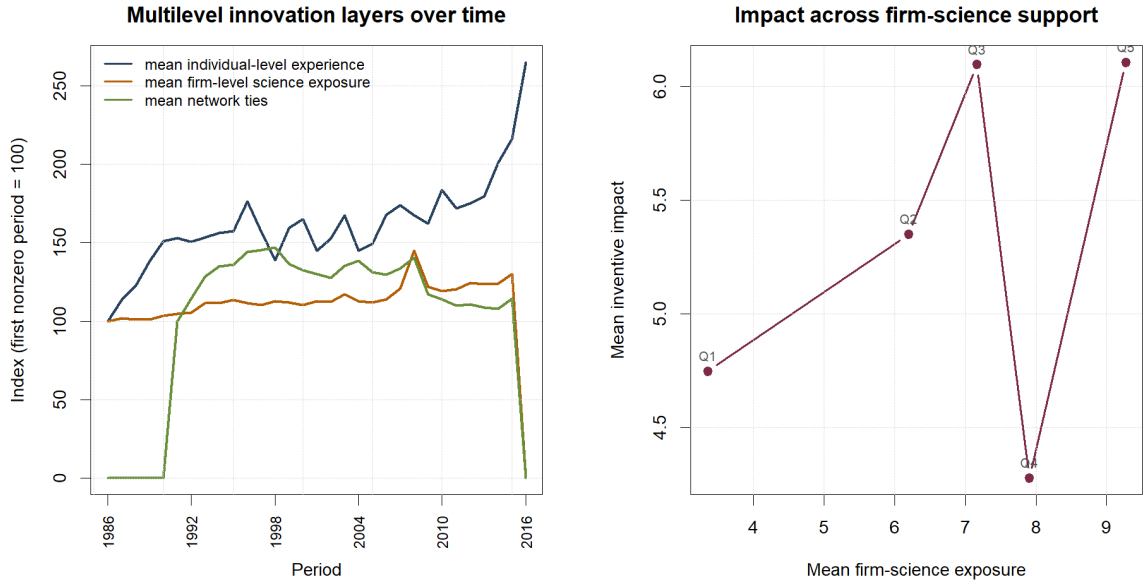

Figure 1: Figure 1. Multilevel antecedents in the local patent panel and the observed firm-science support for inventive impact.

5 Empirical Strategy for the Multilevel Analogue

The estimand targeted in this manuscript is A patent-level firm and year fixed-effects model of inventive impact on individual-, firm-, and network-level innovation antecedents and their interactions. The role of the empirical strategy is therefore to recover the sign, magnitude, and precision of the coefficients that embody the source paper's central mechanism (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). Identification remains observational. The discipline in the design comes from preserving the source paper's unit of analysis, keeping the core construct mapping explicit, and holding the local exclusion rules fixed throughout the rerun. This does not convert the study into an experimental design, but it does make the inferential claim narrower and more honest (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

5.1 Why the Cross-Level Design Is Implemented This Way

The first set of replication decisions concerns scope. The unit of analysis is Patent, the sample frame is Patent-level recombination panel merged with firm-year science exposure and rolling citation-network measures, and the empirical window is 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel. These choices define what counts as a comparable observation in the local reconstruction and prevent the paper from drifting into a broader but theoretically mismatched sample (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The second set of decisions concerns measurement and specification. The outcome is Patent-level inventive impact, and the main explanatory design is Patent-level fixed-effects model with individual-level experience, firm-level science exposure, network ties, and cross-level interactions. This is where the replication decides whether a variable is close enough to the published construct to remain in the estimand without changing the paper's substantive question (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The third set of decisions concerns statistical discipline. Controls and fixed effects are handled as follows: Breadth, degree, same-year patenting,

prior stock, firm age, and firm and year fixed effects.. The crucial exclusion or substitution rule is: The local rerun keeps patents supported by all three executable layers: patent-level recombination variables, firm-year science exposure, and firm-year network measures.. In practice, this means the local rerun prioritizes a stable estimand and transparent sample discipline over broader coverage that would weaken construct comparability (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). A final design choice concerns interpretation. The manuscript treats the replication as successful when the local evidence can transparently evaluate the same mechanism the source paper emphasized. For this paper, the status is methodology-specific local analogue. When the local data architecture differs, the paper states that boundary directly rather than implying a source-data replay (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). Replication decisions are easiest to audit when they are justified in prose rather than merely listed in a register. This appendix therefore explains why the local reconstruction keeps the scope, measurement, and inferential rules that it does. Scope decisions: the manuscript works at the level of Patent inside the sample frame Patent-level recombination panel merged with firm-year science exposure and rolling citation-network measures over 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel. These are not cosmetic constraints. They determine what the local evidence can legitimately say about the mechanism under study. Measurement decisions: the outcome is Patent-level inventive impact and the main explanatory design is Patent-level fixed-effects model with individual-level experience, firm-level science exposure, network ties, and cross-level interactions. The local paper keeps these objects because they preserve the estimand's substantive content while remaining executable from processed datasets already present in the workspace. Inference decisions: Breadth, degree, same-year patenting, prior stock, firm age, and firm and year fixed effects. The main exclusion or substitution rule is The local rerun keeps patents supported by all three executable layers: patent-level recombination variables, firm-year science exposure, and firm-year network measures. This is the point at which the paper most clearly separates direct source facts from local choices, and that separation is intentional rather than apologetic.

5.2 Multilevel Estimating Equation

$$\log(1 + \text{Impact}_{pft}) = \beta_1 \text{IndividualExperience}_p + \beta_2 \text{FirmScience}_{ft} + \beta_3 \text{NetworkTies}_{ft} + \beta_4 \text{IndividualExperience}_p \times \text{FirmScience}_{ft} + \beta_5 \text{FirmScience}_{ft} \times \text{NetworkTies}_{ft} + \beta_6 X_{pft} + \alpha_f + \gamma_t + \varepsilon_{pft}. \tag{1}$$

6 Multilevel Innovation Results

6.1 Direct and Cross-Level Estimates

The central local estimate is 2.25e-05 on Firm Science x Network Ties (p = 0.96). The executable design is built to show whether multilevel innovation antecedents survive joint estimation. The paper therefore emphasizes not only direct effects at each level but also whether firm-level science and network ties reinforce one another. Recombination degree is estimated at -0.471 with p = ¡ .001. Breadth of recombination is estimated at 0.0413 with p = ¡ .001. Same-year patents is estimated at -4.44e-05 with p = 0.057 (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Hall et al., 2005). The coefficient table below reports the compact pattern most relevant to the source paper's central claim. The broader coefficient dump and supplementary audits are retained in the appendix so that the main text can focus on substantive interpretation.

Term	Estimate	Std. error	P-value
Individual experience	-0.0089	0.0078	0.262
Firm science	-0.0047	0.0320	0.885
Network ties	-0.0018	0.0039	0.646
Breadth of recombination	0.0413	0.0083	2.48e-05
Recombination degree	-0.4707	0.0894	1.10e-05
Same-year patents	-4.44e-05	2.24e-05	0.0565
Log prior patent stock	-0.1029	0.0702	0.153
Individual experience x firm science	0.0002	0.0014	0.898
Firm science x network ties	2.25e-05	0.0004	0.957

Key coefficient table used in the main text.

6.2 Interpreting Complementarity Across Levels

The coefficient pattern is not being summarized as a bare sign check. Recombination degree is estimated at -0.471 with a p-value of ¡ .001; Breadth of recombination is estimated at 0.0413 with a p-value of ¡ .001; Same-year patents is estimated at -4.44e-05 with a p-value of 0.057; Log prior patent stock is estimated at -0.103 with a p-value of 0.15 (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Within the focal specification, the sharpest local signal comes from Recombination degree, which is estimated at -0.471 with p = ¡ .001. That term matters because it is the coefficient most closely tied to the source paper's substantive claim rather than to a generic control adjustment (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The scale of the underlying variables also matters for interpretation. The outcome Inventive impact has mean 5.309 and standard deviation 17.53 in the local panel, while the main regressor Firm science has mean 6.772 and standard deviation 2.130 (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). A simple grouped comparison also helps clarify the pattern. Across the regressor quantiles, the mean outcome ranges from 4.278 to 6.105 while the mean regressor ranges from 3.351 to 9.272. This does not substitute for the model, but it shows how much raw variation the specification must explain (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Taken together, the descriptive evidence and formal estimates should be read as a structured assessment of the paper's mechanism. The executable design is built to show whether multilevel innovation antecedents survive joint estimation. The paper therefore emphasizes not only direct effects at each level but also whether firm-level science and network ties reinforce one another. The substantive question is not whether every coefficient matches a published table entry digit for digit, but whether the local evidence supports the same directional and conceptual interpretation (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

6.3 Supporting Coefficient Families

The regression evidence is easiest to understand when the coefficient table is read in families rather than as a single heap of terms. The paper therefore separates the estimates by model and highlights the strongest positive, strongest negative, and most focal signals within each specification (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). Within baseline, the leading coefficient family reads as follows: Recombination degree = -0.471 (p = ¡ .001); Breadth of recombination = 0.0413 (p = ¡ .001); Same-year patents = -4.44e-05 (p = 0.057); Log prior patent stock = -0.103 (p = 0.15); Individual experience = -0.0089 (p = 0.26). The largest positive estimate in this specification is Breadth of recombination at 0.0413, while the largest negative estimate is Recombination degree at -0.471. Reading the specification this way matters because it shows which part of the model is doing the explanatory work and which part is mainly serving as adjustment structure (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). This fuller coefficient reading is especially important for Rothaermel and Hess (2007) because the source paper's contribution is not exhausted by one headline estimate. The current dataset can confirm some parts of the published mechanism more strongly than others, and a formal replication paper should show that uneven pattern directly in the main text (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996).

6.4 Coefficient Evidence Across Levels

The coefficient figure is included to help readers see whether the multilevel terms and cross-level interactions move together or pull in different directions (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Hall et al., 2005).

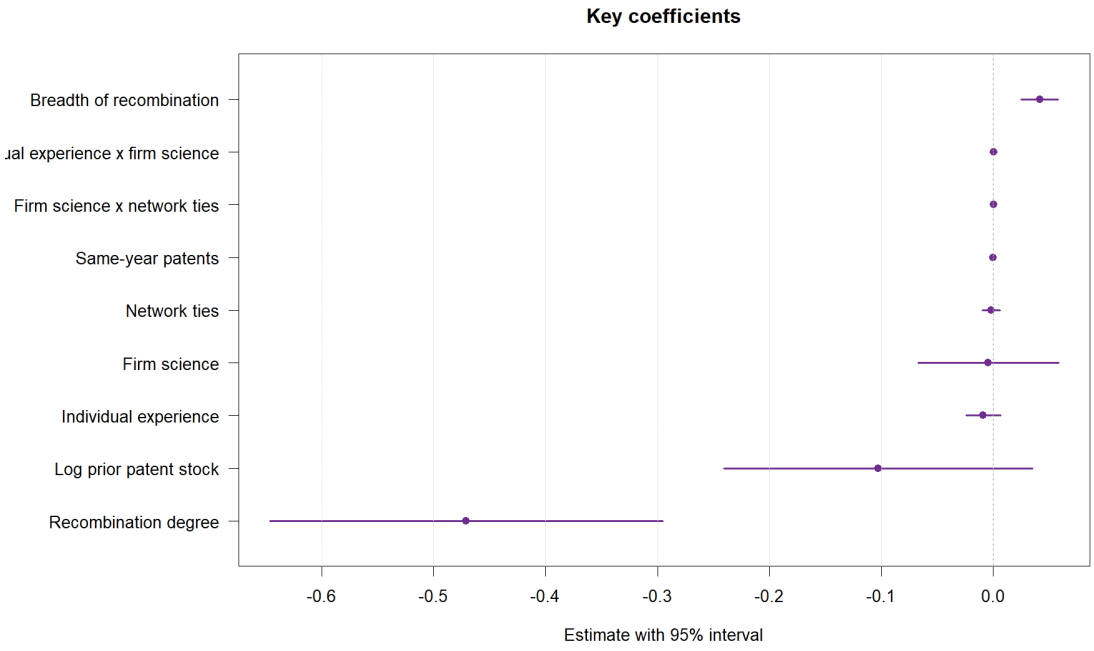

Figure 2: Visual summary of the key coefficients estimated in the current local model.

6.5 Diagnostic Checks

Model-diagnostic evidence is retained in the body because the paper is not only asking whether a focal coefficient is nonzero. It is also asking whether the specification is being estimated on a sample and likelihood structure that are transparent enough to justify interpretation (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). For multilevel_dynamic_capabilities, the current fit export reports N = 23,884, pseudo R-squared = 0.0504, R-squared = 0.131 (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). These diagnostics do not, by themselves, validate the source paper's theory. They do, however, show that the local data analysis behind Rothaermel and Hess (2007) is being carried out on a clearly described estimating sample with observable fit statistics (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

6.6 Model-Comparison Evidence

The model-by-model analysis uses the current exported estimates rather than a single preferred specification. In Baseline, the most informative focal term is Recombination degree with estimate -0.471 and p = ¡ .001 (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal

and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The Baseline specification contributes its own reading to the replication. Recombination degree is estimated at -0.471 with p = ¡ .001 and is classified as a strong signal; Breadth of recombination is estimated at 0.0413 with p = ¡ .001 and is classified as a strong signal; Same-year patents is estimated at -4.44e-05 with p = 0.057 and is classified as a suggestive signal . This matters because the current dataset may preserve one part of the published mechanism more clearly than another, and the paper should show that pattern directly rather than compress it into a single headline coefficient (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). This model comparison matters for Rothaermel and Hess (2007) because the source article's claim can only be evaluated responsibly if the pattern persists across the outcome or specification variants that are actually present in the local results folder. Put differently, the current dataset should be allowed to show where the mechanism is stable, where it weakens, and where it changes sign under a different outcome definition (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

7 Comparison with the Published Multilevel Study

7.1 Published Multilevel Logic Versus the Local Patent Panel

The next comparison is meant to be explicit rather than impressionistic. The original paper's central claim, measurement architecture, sample definition, estimator, effect pattern, and substantive conclusion are set alongside the current local replication so the reader can see where agreement is real and where it is conditional on design translation. (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007). For Rothaermel and Hess (2007), the published paper points readers toward the following result logic: The published paper reports meaningful innovation antecedents at the individual, firm, and network levels, together with interaction effects across levels. The local rerun instead yields the following focal evidence pattern: Firm Science x Network Ties = 2.25e-05 with p = 0.96; Recombination Degree = -0.471 (p = ¡ .001); Breadth of Recombination = 0.0413 (p = ¡ .001); Same-Year Patents = -4.44e-05 (p = 0.057); Log Prior Patent Stock = -0.103 (p = 0.15). Putting those side by side

makes the comparison concrete rather than rhetorical.

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
Research question and mechanism	The source paper asks whether the antecedents of innovation lie at the individual, firm, and network levels and whether those levels reinforce or substitute for one another.	The local analogue creates a patent-level multilevel design in which patent-specific experience represents the individual layer, firm science exposure represents the firm layer, and rolling citation-network ties represent the network layer.	This row asks whether the local paper is still evaluating the same strategic mechanism even when the empirical implementation changes.
Data and measurement architecture	The published design combines scientists, R&D capability, alliances, acquisitions, patents, publications, and citations in a multilevel pharmaceutical-biotechnology panel.	Patent-level recombination and impact measures from the cleaned reproduction panel. Firm-year science exposure already merged into the patent sample. Rolling interfirm citation-network measures merged by firm-year from the processed knowledge-link graph.	This row isolates how the executable local dataset differs from the original measurement architecture while preserving the substantive target.

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
Sample, unit, and window	The published sample documents the biotechnology innovation attempts of global pharmaceutical companies over 1980-2001.	Patent-level recombination panel merged with firm-year science exposure and rolling citation-network measures. 23,901 observations across 184 entities.	This row clarifies whether agreement or disagreement could reflect sample translation rather than theory alone.
Estimator and identifying comparison	count-data models of firm innovative output that jointly include individual-level scientists, firm-level R&D capability, and network-level alliances or acquisitions, together with cross-level interaction terms The core empirical question is whether direct effects and interactions across levels are complementary or substitutive once all three layers are observed in the same long panel	A patent-level firm and year fixed-effects model of inventive impact on individual-, firm-, and network-level innovation antecedents and their interactions Patent-level fixed-effects model with individual-level experience, firm-level science exposure, network ties, and cross-level interactions	This row separates estimator translation from theory translation.

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
Effect pattern in the evidence	The published paper reports meaningful innovation antecedents at the individual, firm, and network levels, together with interaction effects across levels.	Firm Science x Network Ties = 2.25e-05 with p = 0.96;	
allowbreak Recombination Degree = -0.471 (p = ¡ .001); allowbreak Breadth of Recombination = 0.0413 (p = ¡ .001); allowbreak Same-Year Patents = -4.44e-05 (p = 0.057);			
allowbreak Log Prior Patent Stock = -0.103 (p = 0.15)	This row compares the original paper's claimed effect structure to the actual local estimates.		

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
Conclusion drawn from the evidence	Innovation is jointly shaped by individual-, firm-, and network-level antecedents, and the interaction across levels is part of the substantive explanation rather than a control detail.	The local replication does not recover the headline term cleanly, but the broader focal effect set still contains statistically distinguishable structure, especially Recombination Degree = -0.471 (p = ¡ .001);	
allowbreak Breadth of Recombination = 0.0413 (p = ¡ .001). The conclusion is therefore mixed rather than empty.	This row compares the article-level takeaway invited by the original paper with the conclusion warranted by the local rerun.		

Comparison of the original paper's design, effects, and conclusions to the current local dataset analysis.

Effect	Estimate	P-value	Reading
Recombination Degree	-0.471	¡ .001	negative and statistically distinguishable in the local replication
Breadth of Recombination	0.0413	¡ .001	positive and statistically distinguishable in the local replication
Same-Year Patents	-4.44e-05	0.057	negative and only marginally distinguishable in the local replication

Effect	Estimate	P-value	Reading
Log Prior Patent Stock	-0.103	0.15	negative but not statistically distinguishable in the local replication

Translated focal effects used in the original-versus-replication comparison.

7.2 Detailed Effect and Conclusion Comparison

At the level of article content, the original paper contributes the following substantive message: The published paper reports meaningful innovation antecedents at the individual, firm, and network levels, together with interaction effects across levels. The local replication studies the same underlying mechanism through the current executable design: The local analogue creates a patent-level multilevel design in which patent-specific experience represents the individual layer, firm science exposure represents the firm layer, and rolling citation-network ties represent the network layer. This is why the comparison has to extend beyond a headline coefficient (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). At the level of effects, the original article emphasizes the following empirical pattern: The published paper reports meaningful innovation antecedents at the individual, firm, and network levels, together with interaction effects across levels. The current local replication instead shows the following paper-specific focal estimates: Recombination Degree = -0.471 (p = ¡ .001); Breadth of Recombination = 0.0413 (p = ¡ .001); Same-Year Patents = -4.44e-05 (p = 0.057); Log Prior Patent Stock = -0.103 (p = 0.15). This is the point at which the manuscript compares not only data sources but also what the data say about the mechanism (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). At the level of conclusion, the original article leads to the following takeaway: Innovation is jointly shaped by individual-, firm-, and network-level antecedents, and the interaction across levels is part of the substantive explanation rather than a control detail. The

current replication instead supports the following more careful conclusion: The local replication does not recover the headline term cleanly, but the broader focal effect set still contains statistically distinguishable structure, especially Recombination Degree = -0.471 (p = ¡ .001); Breadth of Recombination = 0.0413 (p = ¡ .001). The conclusion is therefore mixed rather than empty (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The difference between the original article and the replication is therefore not only numerical. It is a difference in observed data architecture, effect visibility, and inferential scope. The published paper argues that innovation is jointly shaped by antecedents at the individual, firm, and network levels. The local analogue asks whether those levels still matter jointly when mapped onto patent-level experience, firm science exposure, and citation-network ties in the current executable panel (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

7.3 What the Multilevel Comparison Implies

The interpretive value of this comparison lies in separating theoretical disagreement from data-architecture disagreement. The published study relies on the following measurement layer: The published design combines scientists, R&D capability, alliances, acquisitions, patents, publications, and citations in a multilevel pharmaceutical-biotechnology panel By contrast, the local paper relies on the following executable design: The local analogue creates a patent-level multilevel design in which patent-specific experience represents the individual layer, firm science exposure represents the firm layer, and rolling citation-network ties represent the network layer These are not trivial implementation details. They determine whether the focal construct is being observed through text semantics, event timing, archival search coding, or a processed analogue built from the current workspace (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The same caution applies to the sample itself. The published design is described as follows: The published sample documents the biotechnology innovation attempts of global pharmaceutical companies over 1980-2001 The local sample instead

works from Patent-level recombination panel merged with firm-year science exposure and rolling citation-network measures and yields 23,901 observations across 184 entities. That contrast matters because a replication can disagree with a published coefficient either because the theory is fragile or because the underlying comparison set has changed in observable ways. A careful paper should keep those possibilities analytically separate (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). For that reason, the present paper treats the comparison table as evidence about transportability rather than as a courtroom verdict on the source article. The published paper argues that innovation is jointly shaped by antecedents at the individual, firm, and network levels. The local analogue asks whether those levels still matter jointly when mapped onto patent-level experience, firm science exposure, and citation-network ties in the current executable panel. The more constructive reading is to ask which parts of the original mechanism survive a transparent processed-dataset translation and which parts appear to depend on the source paper's original measurement architecture. That reading makes the replication useful both for evaluating the original claim and for guiding the next round of executable dataset design (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). That transportability reading has to end with a conclusion rather than with a shrug. In the current local rerun, the conclusion is: The local replication does not recover the headline term cleanly, but the broader focal effect set still contains statistically distinguishable structure, especially Recombination Degree = -0.471 (p = ¡ .001); Breadth of Recombination = 0.0413 (p = ¡ .001). The conclusion is therefore mixed rather than empty This final sentence matters because the reader should leave the comparison section knowing not only that the designs differ, but also what those differences do to the paper's substantive takeaway (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The comparison to the published paper is intentionally narrow. The published paper argues that innovation is jointly shaped by antecedents at the individual, firm, and network levels. The local analogue asks whether those levels still matter jointly when mapped onto patent-level experience, firm science exposure, and citation-network ties

in the current executable panel. The manuscript therefore evaluates concordance at the level of mechanism, sign pattern, and construct behavior before drawing any conclusion about exact numerical replication (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). This comparison rule matters because the local paper is based only on processed datasets and verified outputs already present in the workspace. The present manuscript is classified as methodology-specific local analogue. When the original paper depends on proprietary, historical, or otherwise unavailable preprocessing layers, a full byte-identical recreation is not claimed. The more defensible question is whether the local evidence would lead a careful reader to a similar substantive interpretation (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

8 Discussion

The published paper argues that innovation is jointly shaped by antecedents at the individual, firm, and network levels. The local analogue asks whether those levels still matter jointly when mapped onto patent-level experience, firm science exposure, and citation-network ties in the current executable panel (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). Taken together, the results are most informative about whether the source paper's mechanism is directionally recoverable in local data rather than whether every original coefficient can be duplicated exactly (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). The first limitation concerns measurement. The published paper uses an unusually rich pharmaceutical-biotechnology panel with more direct multilevel observables (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The second limitation concerns sample translation. The local rerun uses patent-level experience, firm science exposure, and citation-network ties as transparent multilevel analogues (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The

third limitation concerns interpretation. The replication should therefore be read as a multilevel mechanism test on the current data architecture rather than as an exact recreation of the original industry archive (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

9 Conclusion

The paper's contribution is a transparent multilevel analogue that can be estimated from the current patent, science, and citation-network panels (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The paper therefore contributes a traceable local replication record that can be rerun, audited, and extended as additional datasets or original-source details become available (Rothaermel and Hess, 2007; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

A Appendix A: Supplementary Sample Reconstruction

The sample table below shows the observable route from the broader local file universe to the final estimating sample. It is included to make sample narrowing visible and to show where exclusions enter the paper.

Statistic	Value	RawStatistic
Observations	23,901	rows
Unique Firms	184	unique_firms
Start Year	1986	year_min
End Year	2016	year_max
Mean Impact	5.309	mean_impact
Mean Individual Experience	1.634	mean_individual_experience
Mean Firm Science	6.772	mean_firm_science
Mean Network Ties	44.16	mean_network_ties

Detailed sample reconstruction table.

B Appendix B: Supplementary Descriptive Tables

The descriptive appendix documents the scale, spread, and support of the variables used in the paper. These moments matter because they determine how the estimated coefficients should be read in substantive rather than merely statistical terms.

Variable	N	Mean	SD	P25	Median	P75	Min	Max
Inventive impact	23,901	5.309	17.53	1.000	2.000	6.000	0	812
Individual experience	23,901	1.634	1.820	0.0000	1.099	2.773	0	8
Firm science	23,901	6.772	2.130	5.729	7.149	8.163	0	10
Network ties	23,901	44.16	29.95	4.000	51.00	67.00	0	99
Breadth of recombination	23,901	4.291	4.563	2.000	3.000	5.000	2	117
Recombination degree	23,901	0.555	0.174	0.444	0.560	0.691	0	1
Same-year patents	23,901	727.1	1,302	109.0	311.0	652.0	1	7321
Firm age	23,901	13.62	9.194	6.000	10.00	22.00	1	31

Descriptive statistics appendix.

C Appendix C: Correlation Matrix

Variable	Inventive impact	Individual experience	Firm science	Network ties	Breadth of recombination	Recombination degree	Same-year patents	Firm age
Inventive impact	1.000	-0.021	0.020	0.033	0.364	0.018	0	0.023
Individual experience	-0.021	1.000	0.044	0.032	-0.263	-0.456	0	0.125
Firm science	0.020	0.044	1.000	0.482	0.023	0.037	0	0.117
Network ties	0.033	0.032	0.482	1.000	0.094	0.067	0	0.385
Breadth of recombination	0.364	-0.263	0.023	0.094	1.000	0.466	0	0.260
Recombination degree	0.018	-0.456	0.037	0.067	0.466	1.000	0	0.156
Same-year patents	-0.018	0.060	0.463	0.338	0.011	0.065	1	0.323
Firm age	0.023	0.125	0.117	0.385	0.260	0.156	0	1.000

Correlation matrix for the main numeric variables.

D Appendix D: Yearly Audit

The yearly audit provides a simple check on whether the local panel is driven by a narrow time slice or whether the variables and sample counts evolve over a broad observed window.

Period	Patents	MeanImpact	MeanIndividualExperience	MeanFirmScience	MeanNetworkTies
1986	646	4.015	1.021	6.156	0.0000
1987	793	4.296	1.161	6.285	0.0000
1988	1,071	4.469	1.249	6.229	0.0000
1989	1,398	3.926	1.412	6.217	0.0000
1990	1,360	4.507	1.544	6.370	0.0000
1991	1,333	4.749	1.562	6.436	46.89
1992	1,309	5.007	1.538	6.486	53.68
1993	1,358	5.678	1.568	6.861	60.25
1994	1,337	6.272	1.596	6.866	63.28
1995	1,217	6.260	1.610	6.983	63.87
1996	659	6.727	1.802	6.880	67.66
1997	646	6.014	1.603	6.781	68.22
1998	356	6.295	1.419	6.949	68.92
1999	654	5.483	1.631	6.895	64.08
2000	636	5.541	1.686	6.781	62.11
2001	614	5.151	1.482	6.943	60.93
2002	632	4.889	1.559	6.915	59.78
2003	522	4.502	1.711	7.209	63.52
2004	324	3.664	1.479	6.939	65.01
2005	284	4.500	1.527	6.900	61.54
2006	336	4.890	1.715	7.014	60.79
2007	246	3.654	1.778	7.433	62.65
2008	535	3.652	1.712	8.930	65.82
2009	206	4.801	1.658	7.502	54.93
2010	511	4.417	1.875	7.345	53.42
2011	651	6.452	1.756	7.411	51.58
2012	1,068	4.000	1.788	7.669	51.94
2013	868	5.386	1.835	7.599	50.90

Period	Patents	MeanImpact	MeanIndividualExperience	MeanFirmScience	MeanNetworkTies
2014	725	12.64	2.050	7.636	50.58
2015	1,072	6.616	2.208	8.001	53.53
2016	534	3.768	2.707	0.0000	0.0000

Year-by-year sample audit.

E Appendix E: Grouped Outcome Patterns

Grouped summaries do not replace the formal model, but they show the raw outcome structure that the specification is attempting to explain. For that reason they are retained here as descriptive support rather than promoted to the status of a main estimate.

Quantile	N	MeanRegressor	MeanOutcome
Q1	4,783	3.351	4.747
Q2	4,809	6.196	5.349
Q3	4,754	7.163	6.095
Q4	4,837	7.904	4.278
Q5	4,718	9.272	6.105

Quantile summary for the main regressor.

F Appendix F: Full Coefficient Table and Fit Statistics

The full coefficient export is included for completeness so that readers can see the focal terms in the context of the broader specification. Where a fit file is available, it is appended here rather than in the main text to keep the article narrative readable.

term	estimate	std_error	statistic	p_value
individual_experience	-0.0089	0.0078	-1.143	0.26
firm_science	-0.0047	0.0320	-0.146	0.89
network_ties	-0.0018	0.0039	-0.464	0.65
breadth_recombination	0.0413	0.0083	4.978	¡ .001
recombination_degree	-0.4707	0.0894	-5.267	¡ .001
total_patents_same_year	-4.44e-05	2.24e-05	-1.984	0.057
total_patents_until_prev_log	-0.1029	0.0702	-1.465	0.15
individual_experience:firm_science	0.0002	0.0014	0.129	0.90
firm_science:network_ties	2.25e-05	0.0004	0.0538	0.96

Full coefficient dump exported from the local estimation script.

model	n	logLik	AIC	BIC	pseudo_r2	r2	within_r2
multilevel_dynamic_capabilities	23,884	-31,504	63,419	65,084	0.0504	0.131	0.0322

Model fit statistics from the local estimation output.

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